Tin Snips

Category: **Hand Tools - Cutting & Shaping** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 4 labs

Covers these lab items: Tin Cutter -Scissor; Tin Cutter (Tin cutter with spring)

What it is used for

To cut thin sheet metal using tin snips. To produce controlled cuts while keeping the sheet secure and reducing sharp-edge injuries.

Main parts

- Cutting blades
- Handles
- Pivot joint
- Spring or opening mechanism, if fitted
- Locking catch, if fitted

Before you start

1. Select snips suitable for the sheet thickness and cutting direction.
2. Inspect blades, pivot, handles, and spring for damage.
3. Mark the cutting line clearly.
4. Secure the sheet and wear safety glasses and cut-resistant gloves suitable for the task.

How to use

1. Open the snips and position the sheet between the blades.
2. Align the blades with the marked cutting line.
3. Hold the handles firmly and cut using steady squeezes.
4. Advance along the line without twisting the blades excessively.
5. Support the sheet to prevent it bending or dropping unexpectedly.
6. Deburr or safely handle the cut edge as required.
7. Close and lock the snips after use.

⚠ Safety

- Keep fingers clear of the cutting blades and sharp sheet edges.
- Do not cut material thicker than the tool's rating.
- Wear eye protection against flying metal fragments.
- Do not use snips with loose pivots or damaged blades.

Care & storage

- Wipe metal debris from the blades after use.
- Keep the pivot clean and lubricate as specified.

- Inspect cutting edges regularly.
- Store with the blades closed and locked.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using snips unsuitable for the material thickness.
- Twisting the tool and damaging the blades.
- Holding sharp sheet edges with bare hands.
- Leaving snips open during storage.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.